

**CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED BY VEGETABLE
FARMERS IN VICTORIAS CITY**

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ABSTRACT

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Challenges and problems in vegetable farming has been always part of the agricultural process. Smallholder or small-scale vegetable farmers in Victorias City encountered challenges in vegetable farming such as lack of facility, lack of farm inputs, problems on proper information dissemination for farmers and poor market access. These challenges encountered by vegetable farmers significantly affect their production process and resulted to the decreasing number of farmers engaging in growing vegetable crops. This study aimed to determine the extent of challenges encountered by vegetable farmers in terms of Knowledge and skills, Availability of agricultural infrastructure, High cost and limited access to farm inputs, Access to financial resources, Availability of farm machines, tools and equipment and Access to market. The respondents of the study were 45 identified vegetable farmers in Victorias City. Purposive sampling was used in identifying the respondents to hit the criteria of the respondents. The study used a quantitative descriptive design. A self-made validated 30 item questionnaire was utilized in this study. The result of the study showed that the respondents over-all response in challenges encountered the high cost and limited access to farm inputs was at high extent harboring a mean percentage of 2.93. In line with this, study proves that the high cost and limited access to farm input was the most challenge encountered by the vegetable farmers in Victorias City.



The study's findings reflected a difference between High cost and limited access to farm inputs and availability of farm machine, tools and equipment in terms of sex. In addition, no significant difference existed between knowledge and skills, availability of agricultural infrastructure, access to financial resources and Access to market in terms of age, educational attainment and farm area.